

HAPPY FACTORY

Game Draft • Satirical Time-Management Puzzle / Narrative Subversion

THEME	HOW THE GAME EMBODIES IT
1. COMIC	The entire game is presented through a bright comic-book language: chibi characters, bold black outlines, pop-art color blocks, exaggerated expressions, spray-painted/stenciled graphics and punchy UI feedback. The cheerful visual absurdity makes the later revelation more jarring.
2. TWIST	The moral twist is built into the player's performance. Playing well means becoming an increasingly efficient contributor to the machinery of mass murder; playing badly means failing quotas and potentially becoming expendable yourself. The same success system therefore acquires a completely different meaning once the player understands what the factory produces.
3. LIGHT	Lighting is a narrative mechanic. As the story becomes darker, the world literally loses its light: bright morning yellows/cyan → warm afternoon hues → purple/crimson dusk → navy/red emergency lighting → near-black midnight. The visual brightness and moral darkness move in opposite directions.

CORE CONCEPT

HAPPY FACTORY looks like a harmless, addictive assembly-line game. The player controls a wide-eyed factory worker, completes mechanical work orders, hits quotas, earns gold stars and receives enthusiastic praise from a pushy manager. Over five levels, increasingly specific work requirements, phone conversations and environmental changes reveal that the factory is serving Nazi Germany's war machine and the Final Solution.

Core dramatic contradiction: the game rewards the player for becoming better at something they increasingly understand they should not be helping accomplish.

GAMEPLAY LOOP

Receive ticket → assemble → operate controls → seal/test → beat timer → receive rating → repeat. Players drag abstract containers and components such as filters, valves and heavy latches, then operate levers/valves to satisfy specifications before the timer expires. Accuracy and speed determine stars, bonuses and progression.

Overheard dialogue: The Manager periodically takes calls from the General. The player can continue working while snippets gradually transform ordinary-sounding industrial jargon into disturbing context.

FIVE-LEVEL NARRATIVE / LIGHTING ARC

1 — MORNING	Bright yellow + cyan	Cheerful arcade music. Simple assembly work. The player learns the satisfying productivity loop.
2 — AFTERNOON	Warm orange + purple	Longer shadows. "Airtight transit specifications" introduce the first serious anomaly.
3 — DUSK	Deep purple + crimson	"Rail car density" and "high volume" enter phone conversations. Metallic sparks puncture the increasingly dark scene.
4 — TWILIGHT	Navy + neon red	Claustrophobic framing. Orders reference "special facilities in the East." The manager remains cheerful.
5 — MIDNIGHT	Almost black + single spotlight	Arcade music cuts out. Engines and tank treads dominate. The General arrives for the final inspection.

THE TWIST: PERFORMANCE BECOMES MORAL CHOICE

The player's score is deliberately morally unstable. A high-performing player is not simply "winning": they are making the factory more efficient and therefore increasing its capacity to produce death. A player who deliberately performs poorly disrupts production, but the factory's system is also dangerous to the worker: missed quotas, mistakes and inefficiency can lead to punishment or death. **There is no clean heroic score.** The game uses the familiar language of stars, bonuses and performance ratings to force the player to reconsider what those rewards actually represent.

Design goal: The player should initially think, "I need to get better at this game." By the end, the question becomes, "What exactly am I getting better at?"

CHARACTERS & PRESENTATION

Player Worker	Wide-eyed, innocent chibi worker in an oversized jumpsuit. Their desire is simple: hit the quota and keep their job.
Manager	Perky bureaucrat with oversized round glasses, clipboard and gold stars. His positivity becomes increasingly grotesque as context changes.
The General	Only a phone voice in Levels 1–4. Appears physically in Level 5 as a rigid WWII German high-command officer stepping from a tank.

CLIMAX & FINAL IMAGE

At midnight, the General inspects the final part, approves it and awards the player a **Worker of the Month** medal. For one beat, the game presents this exactly like a triumphant arcade ending. Then the camera pulls back to reveal a sprawling industrial map of occupied Europe behind the cute worker. The medal, stars and cheerful factory aesthetic are reframed as symbols of complicity rather than achievement.

Final thematic statement: HAPPY FACTORY weaponizes the language of a comic, cheerful productivity game to create a twist in which success has moral consequences, while the literal loss of light mirrors the player's growing awareness of what their work means.